

Denmark Itinerary

By Desk2Destinations

desk2destinations.com

June 14, 2026

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Copenhagen in One Day: A Driverless Metro, Tivoli Without Rides & an Accidental Triathlon

We rolled into Copenhagen on **17th August** at an hour that was barely morning, eyes red from a FlixBus that had crossed two countries while we slept. Within an hour, a **driverless metro** had silently pulled out of the platform with us inside, and one of us said out loud — *"there's no one driving this train"* — like a child noticing the moon for the first time. Copenhagen does that. It quietly shows you a future you didn't know was already running.

Day 1: 17th August

A Driverless Metro & a Hostel With a French Family

From the bus station we caught the **Copenhagen Metro** — fully automated, no driver's cabin, just glass walls at both ends of the train. You can stand at the very front and watch the tunnel disappear under you. We watched. Twice. Even other passengers smiled at our wide-eyed nonsense. Hyderabad's metro is fine; Copenhagen's metro feels like science fiction that someone forgot to make a big deal about.

The hostel was a **shared room with a French family** — a mother, a father, a teenage daughter, three rolling suitcases, and the kind of warm, polite chaos that only French families abroad seem to manage. We did the small wave, the small *"bonjour,"* dropped our bags, and walked back out into the city before sleep could catch us.

Day 1

Tivoli Gardens — A Walking Tour, No Rides

We had a soft pass for **Tivoli Gardens** — the 1843 pleasure garden in the centre of the city — and a deliberate decision: *no rides today*. Disneyland Paris was a few weeks down our itinerary, and we'd promised ourselves to save the screaming for there. Instead, Tivoli became a slow, beautiful walk: the wooden roller coaster (built in 1914) clacking somewhere overhead, the Japanese-pagoda restaurant glowing in mid-afternoon light, the pantomime stage closed but lovely, the gardens full of locals eating soft-serve as if it were a national right.

There's a particular pleasure in walking through an amusement park without queueing for anything. You see the people-watching, the architecture, the way the place was actually designed to be experienced before "thrills" became its export product. Tivoli is, at heart, a garden. We treated it like one.

"There's no one driving this train." Copenhagen's quiet superpower is that it shows you the future and refuses to brag about it — a driverless metro, a city that bikes more than it drives, a 19th-century pleasure garden that still works.

Day 1

Nyhavn & an Accidental Triathlon

Late afternoon we walked to **Nyhavn** — the harbour canal with the colourful 17th-century merchant houses that every Copenhagen postcard is built on. The water was full of small wooden boats; the outdoor tables were full of people drinking €10 beers without flinching. We sat on the harbour wall, feet swinging over the water, and watched.

That's when we noticed it: a **triathlon** was running through the city. Swimmers had just finished a leg in the harbour beside us, dripping into transition tents; cyclists were curving past the Royal Theatre; runners — calves the size of bread loaves — were finishing their loops along the canal. We had walked into Copenhagen and Copenhagen had, very politely, walked a triathlon around us. Both of us laughed about it for the rest of the evening — the only city that could make us feel out of shape by accident.

Dinner was warm, simple, and finished early. We were back at the hostel by 9, the French family already asleep with their reading lights still on. Tomorrow was Malmö, and we had a train to catch.

Must-Visit in Copenhagen (in One Day)

- **Copenhagen Metro:** Ride the driverless line. Stand at the front. Smile.
- **Tivoli Gardens (walk, no rides):** Especially good if you have a bigger park later in the trip.
- **Nyhavn harbour wall:** Sit, don't dine. The view is the point.
- **Torvehallerne food hall:** For smørrebrød done properly.
- **Christiansborg tower:** Free, best skyline view in the city.
- **Round Tower (Rundetårn):** Spiralling ramp, not stairs — a 17th-century novelty.
- **City cycling:** Hire a bike. Locals will forgive most mistakes politely.

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